Dezerv Hackathon: Project Proposal & Research Report

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1. Executive User Research Insights (Tabular Analysis from 11 Teen Interviews)

Research Area	Key Behavioral Pattern & Insights	App Implication
Funding Models	Most teens operate on an on-demand funding model (requesting money as needs arise) rather than fixed allowances. A minority receives fixed monthly allowances (₹500–₹5000), where some save consistently while others deplete funds in 10–15 days.	Dual onboarding paths: On-demand approval flow vs. automated savings tracking.
Spending Categories	Expenses are heavily concentrated in two primary buckets: Food/snacks/tuck shops and travel/auto-rickshaw commute fares, followed by occasional shopping/hobbies.	Tailored categorization system focusing specifically on teen lifestyle buckets.
Payment Instruments	Heavy reliance on digital apps (GPay, FamPay, UPI) linked to parent accounts. Teens prefer setting a threshold (₹500–₹2000) to avoid asking permission for micro-transactions.	Notification-scraping feature with customizable parental spending thresholds.
Emergency Crises	Impromptu social obligations (e.g., peer birthday parties) cause peer pressure and financial awkwardness when cash is unavailable.	Dedicated "Emergency Cushion" savings module to prevent last-minute crunches.
Goal Structures	Short-term personal savings (shoes, tech) coexist with high-ticket aspirations (MacBooks, higher education) that thrive with parent-teen milestones.	Two-tier goal dashboard linked to academic and behavioral verification.

2. Finalized App Architecture & Planning Points

- **1. Core Hackathon Requirements Met:** Accessible instantly via a web link with no downloads or sign-ins required. Uses simulated/made-up amounts with no real money or personal information collected. Fully addresses all three required hackathon questions (*Where did all my money go?*, *How do I save for that cycle?*, and *Can I buy this, Mum?*).
- **2. Your Three User Categories:** Accommodates teens with pocket money (automated savings and logs take center stage), teens without pocket money (parent-approval card flow primary), and teens who earn independently.
- **3. The Frictionless Expense Tracking System:** Background notification capture from payment apps like FamPay, GPay, and PhonePe. An evening check-in prompt combined with a 5-second drop-down category list (Snacks, Travel, Shopping, Movies, Stationery, Bills) achieves 80%+ accuracy with zero manual typing.
- **4. Savings, Shields, & Milestone Goals:** Features **"The First-Week Shield"** (automatic emergency cushioning right when funds arrive) and Milestone-Based Bigger Goals (tying dream items to board exams or entrance tests via parent photo/screenshot verification).
- **5. Community & Inspiration ("Learn how starsavers save moneyyy!"):** Features anonymized peer wisdom, paper-trail methods, and proven saving hacks while strictly protecting user privacy.

> **Core Value Proposition:** Teaches practical financial literacy early through trade-off visualization, reduces parent-child friction via transparent limits, builds social resilience against peer pressure, and gamifies milestone achievement.